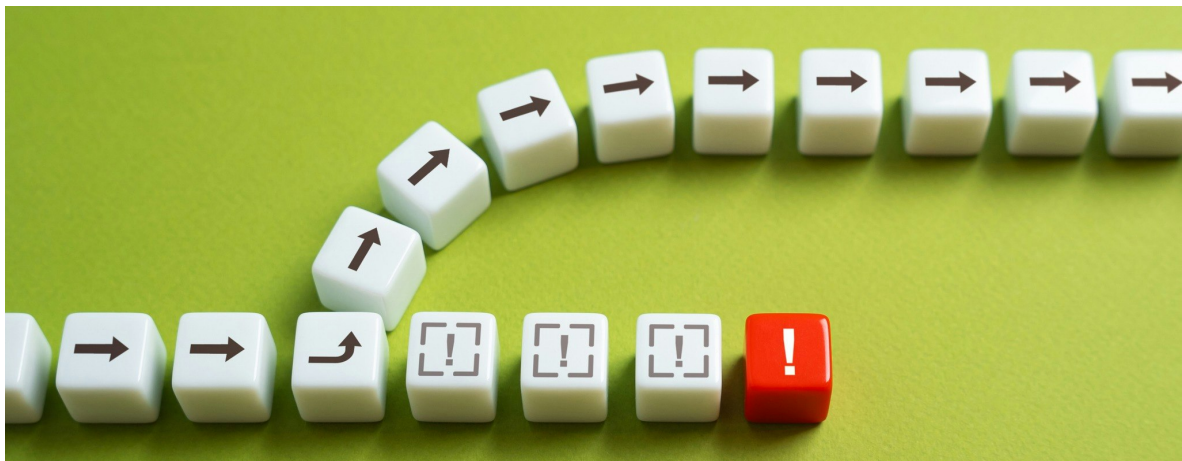




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Authorisation and authentication

Page routing and redirections 10m



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One of the requirements of authentication and authorisation is that sometimes a client needs to be directed away from one page and towards another. There are two alternative scenarios:

Authentication: A page requires the client to be logged in. If a client arrives at the page without being logged in, they need to be redirected to the login page.

Authorisation: A client is logged in, but they arrive at a page that requires access rights that they do not have. They need to be redirected to an alternative page.

To redirect a client in a PHP web application, the **header** function is used, which defines a URL as a location in its parameter list. Here, for example, the client is redirected to the index page. Note that after calling the header function, the **exit** function should also be called to prevent any further code in the page being executed after the redirection has taken place.

```
<?php  
  
header('Location: index.php');  
  
exit ();  
  
...
```

The header function (The PHP Documentation Group, n.d.) modifies information in the HTTP request, which means the PHP header function **MUST** be the first thing used before you send or return any HTML or PHP content.

Rerouting a user due to authentication and authorisation reasons

Several helpful functions can be added to a PHP file that can be included when managing sessions in a PHP web application.

For example, it will be useful to be able to return the current login state of the user who is associated with the session as a string to display their status on web pages, as in this **loginStatus** function.

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Copy

```
1  function loginStatus()  
2  {  
3    $username = $_SESSION['username'];  
4    if ($_SESSION['loggedin'] == true)  
5      return$_SESSION['username'];  
6    else  
7      return 'no login credentials';  
8  }
```

gistfile1.txt hosted with ❤️ by GitHub

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Thoughts on this page?

